

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥5

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥8

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 2NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣6

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥6

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥5

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 5 4

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 9 3 2

♣ A 3

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ K Q 10

♦ A J 7

♣ Q 10 8



♠ 6 2

♥ J 9 6 5

♦ Q 8 5 4

♣ 9 6 5

♠ A 7

♥ A 8 4

♦ K 10 6

♣ K J 7 4 2

NORTH has a great 1NT hand - 17 points and 4-3-3-3 shape.

SOUTH has 16 points; he figures it is possible that NORTH can make a slam, but only if she has a 17 point opener. So he bids 4NT, expecting NORTH to bid 6NT if she has 17 points but to pass if she has fewer.

He figured right - NORTH had 17 points so she bid 6NT.

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥5

North

1NT

6NT

East

Pass

South

4NT

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8
♥ A K 5
♦ A 8
♣ Q 10 9 6 3 2

♠ Q 10 9 3

♥ J 4 3

♦ J 6 4 3

♣ 7 5



♠ A 7 4
♥ Q 9 6
♦ K Q 5 2
♣ K J 8

♠ J 6 5 2

♥ 10 8 7 2

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

WEST definitely does NOT have a balanced hand.
She has two doubletons and a 6-card Club suit.

But she DOES have 18 points, (two extra for the fifth and sixth Clubs), and her 18 added to EAST's minimum of 15 is enough to bid 6NT.

Notice how easy this will be to play once that Club suit is established.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

Lead: ♥8

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 7 4 2
♥ 10 4
♦ J 9
♣ A 9 7 6 3

♠ K 8 3

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ 7 4 3

♣ 8 5 2



♠ A 6 5
♥ K Q 8 3
♦ Q 10 8 5
♣ 10 4

♠ Q J 10

♥ A J 7

♦ A K 6 2

♣ K Q J

With 21 points and 4-3-3-3 distribution, SOUTH opens 2NT.

NORTH has just 3 points; he knows that SOUTH cannot have more than 21 so the partnership total cannot be more than 24. So he just passes 2NT.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by South

Lead: ♣6

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 4 2
 ♥ A 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 2
 ♣ A 4 2

♠ Q 10

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q J 10 7

♣ Q J 10 8



♠ K 5 3

♥ K 5 3

♦ K 5 3

♣ K 7 5 3

♠ J 9 8 7 6

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ 9 8

♣ 9 6

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by West

Lead: ♣Q

This is an easy one to bid.

WEST has a balanced 16 points so he opens 1NT.

EAST has a balanced 12 points so she responds 3NT.

BUT - just look at how this would play. You might only be able to take 8 tricks. Sometimes correct bidding gets you to unmakeable contracts. But it's only a game.

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 3
♥ 4 2
♦ 10 8
♣ 10 5 4 3 2

♠ A J 5
♥ Q 10 9 3
♦ K Q J
♣ A K 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 6 4
♥ A 8 7 6
♦ 9 6 5 3
♣ 9 7

♠ K 7 2
♥ K J 5
♦ A 7 4 2
♣ Q J 8

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♥6			

Notrump bidding really is easy, you just add your points to partner's points and then bid according to that answer.

Here SOUTH has 14 points. So when NORTH opens 2NT, showing 20 or 21 points SOUTH knows the total will come to 34 or 35 so he bids 6NT.

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 5
♥ Q 8 4
♦ Q 6 2
♣ Q 7 5 3

♠ J 8 4 2

♥ A 7 2

♦ J 9 8 5

♣ 9 4



♠ A K 6
♥ K 9 3
♦ K 7 4 3
♣ A 6 2

♠ 10 9 3

♥ J 10 6 5

♦ A 10

♣ K J 10 8

West

Pass

All Pass

1NT by East

Lead: ♥5

North

Pass

East

1NT

South

WEST cannot open with only 8 points.

Furthermore, when EAST opens 1NT WEST knows that the partnership has a 25 points at most so he passes again.